

Bolivia

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** November 30, 1851 **Usage:** National and Civil

The order of the stripes was changed to red, yellow, green in 1851. Red and green were retained from the flag of 1825



Red recalls valor

Yellow reflects Bolivia's mineral reserves

Green symbolizes fertility

South America



Bolivia, originally known as Upper Peru, was named after Simón Bolívar who supervised its secession from Spain in 1825.

The flag of 1825 had three stripes of green-red-green, with five gold stars within laurel wreaths. These stood for the original five departments.

A NEW TRICOLOR

In 1826, the flag was altered to three equal stripes of yellow, green and red with the arms in the center. It was

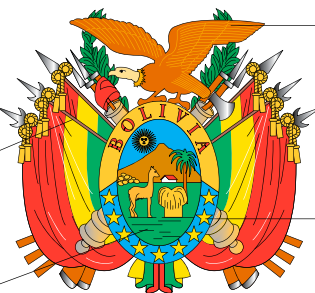
last altered in 1851, when the order of the stripes was changed to red, yellow, green.

The official flag still has the arms in the center. It was regulated in 1888 and depicts Mount Potosí, an alpaca, a sheaf of wheat, and a breadfruit tree. The oval ring contains nine stars for the nine departments.

ARMS OF BOLIVIA

The flags and weapons represent the people's willingness to defend the state

The allegorical scene on the shield represents Bolivia's agricultural and industrial wealth



As on many South American arms, the crest is a condor

The nine stars represent Bolivia's nine departments